

Classic French Onion Soup

Tags: soup, french, dinner, comfort-food | Prep: 20 min | Cook: 90 min | Serves: 3

Ingredients

- 0.9 kg yellow onions, thinly sliced
- 3 tbsp unsalted butter
- 1.5 tbsp olive oil
- 0.8 tsp sugar
- 0.8 tsp fine salt
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1.5 tbsp all-purpose flour
- 187.5 ml dry white wine
- 1.1 litres good beef stock
- 1.5 sprigs fresh marjoram
- 1.5 bay leaves
- 0.8 tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- Salt and black pepper to taste
- 6 thick slices baguette, toasted
- 150 g Gruyère cheese, grated

Method

1. Melt butter with olive oil in a large heavy-based pot over medium heat.
2. Add onions, sugar, and salt. Stir to coat. Cook uncovered, stirring every 5–10 minutes, for 50–60 minutes until deep golden-brown and caramelised.
3. Add garlic and cook for 2 minutes. Stir in flour and cook 1 minute.
4. Pour in wine, scraping any browned bits from the base. Boil for 2 minutes.
5. Add stock, thyme, bay leaves, and Worcestershire sauce. Bring to a boil, then simmer for 20 minutes.
6. Discard thyme sprigs and bay leaves. Taste and season generously.
7. Preheat grill/broiler to high. Ladle soup into oven-safe bowls and place on a baking tray.
8. Float 2 baguette slices on each bowl and pile with Gruyère.
9. Grill for 3–5 minutes until the cheese is bubbling and golden. Serve immediately.

Chef Tips

- Patience is everything — the onions must caramelise slowly for full flavour. Rushing makes bitter onions.
- Use homemade beef stock if possible; it makes a profound difference to depth.
- Soup can be made 3 days ahead and refrigerated; only add bread and cheese to order.